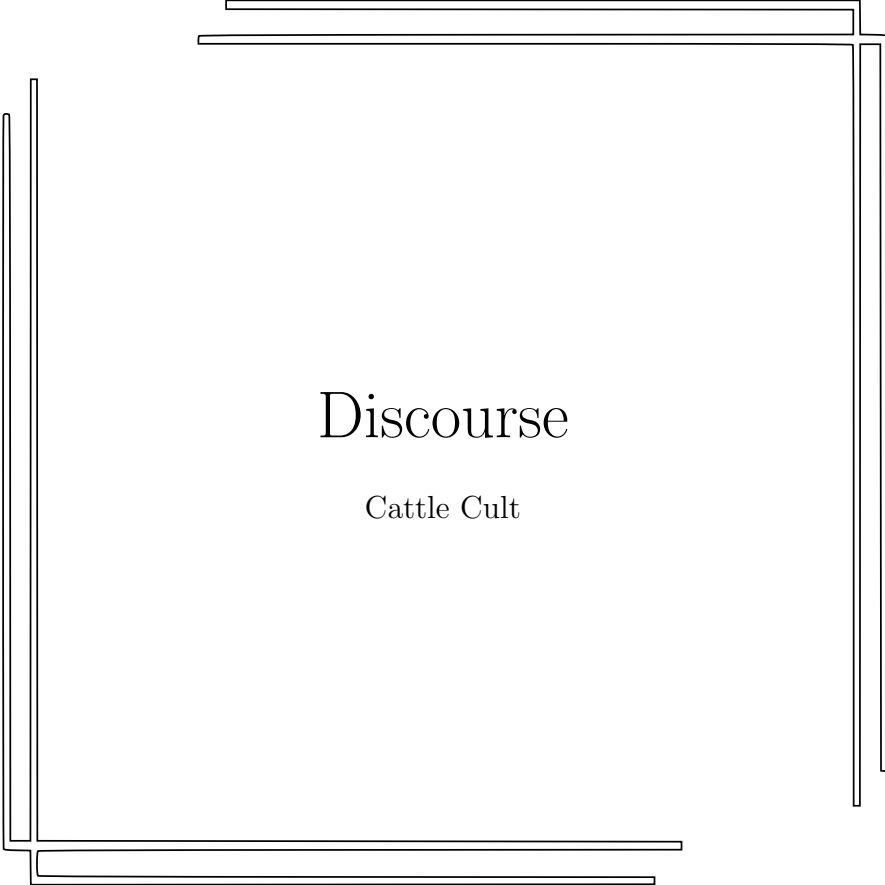




Discourse

Cattle Cult

A knife between friends

You came down and out
Not knowing where you'd be or what
you'd be without
Being full of pity's quite a way to live
So of course I told you off the cuff to
'come on in'

Up front, I'm a Jew
Just the funny kind your mom would
like, not the kind who runs the
news
So I was maybe just a little scared
When you started shouting, raving
that I'd better be prepared

CHORUS

What's a knife between friends?
What's a kindness to be done
and what's a trouble to preempt
What's a person; who's a prob-
lem
And why does the means deal
the same stack of cards as the
ends?

I feel it twisting in my chest
Kind of like a knife, I guess, but

doubtful it compares
Moral angst hits differently, beloved
When the bastard in the mirror is a
shill who isn't buying her own
wares

CHORUS

*What am I doing and why did I come, I
asked two enforcers of order, un-
done
To the magistrate, What's this thing,
'affidavit'?*
"Just irregular, apathetic, atomic vi-
bration"
*What's a libelous roommate; what's a
murderous spouse?*
The clerk replied, "they're just the
same except whose name is on
the house"
Again before Heaven, *Why did I
come? What makes us blush and
what makes us feel numb?*
What's hope? What's desolation?
What makes someone a mother?
"Just bags full of chemicals bumping
into each other."

Who the fuck knows?

Does it cause you cognitive dissonance

When it turns out that the one who said they loved you really didn't?

And does seeing people happy make you angry

Cause your parents fought that Saturday and ruined your fucking picnic?

Does it make it any easier to swallow Your pointless fucking fate to know it's fucking pointless anyway

And will your lawyer even show?

Who the fuck knows?

Would I be doing any differently

If someone hadn't told me time again

I'm just emotionally indulgent?

Do I owe them for the privilege of fulfilling

What I'd never do without another just and proper scolding?

Is there really any telling

What else I would be saying and the rates I would be paying

for the Camaro and the nanny and the clothes?

Who the fuck knows?

CHORUS

Well we're all in this infernal thing together

And every parallel dimension's probably fucked

So instead of frettin' on my scars I'm gonna fret on my guitar

Gonna drink a beer and write a song and give a fuck

Does it cause me cognitive dissonance To be so proudly humanistic but so petty when I'm writing?

Yes it does; I do it anyway

Cause I don't sleep a lot the nights I'm down and I don't feel like fighting

On the other hand it's quite auspicious

Cause I'd otherwise be living as a drone who's ever giving

Of its body and its mind and of its soul

But who the fuck knows?

Well the universe ain't got a lot of answers

But it's got a lot of questions you can ask

That are better for your mind than what the light of what's behind

Has got to show you 'bout the shadows of your past

CHORUS

And instead of liting backlit shadows cast by all my rotten luck

Gonna drink a beer with someone else who gives a fuck

Superfund

What kind of shit you have to step
over to get to me?
Did you miss the tower of cans and
stack of dirty magazines?
Let me show you how I do it left to
mine, my dear
And I'll get you home by ten if you
don't wanna stay here

Check with the ranger at the gate
Get your name badge on your breast
affixed and meet me at the lake
They call it that, but really it's a
pond
But it's full of life you'll never find by
looking at it wrong

CHORUS

Cause I'm a barrel full of mer-
cury darling
I'm an overflowing shitty lagoon
I'm a river full of hydrogen sul-
fide
I'm a picture of a smog-tinted
moon
And I'm a burning stack of tires
at twilight
An impenetrable chlorine haze
I'm a barrel of ammonium ni-
trate
I'm a lazy bureaucratic delay

What kind of nature do you expect to
see?
You'll miss it if you look for some-
thing boring, lush, and green
I can take you to the fertilizer spill
Where I take my lunches in the shade

of the wrongly colored hill
The trees grow weird and crooked by
the lake
With the animals deformed and their
uncountable legs
Do you see the puddle with its irides-
cent sheen?
Do you mind its iridescence beyond
iridescency?

CHORUS

And there are tadpoles in the
languishing craters
Maybe the occasional frog
Just know that I'm a Superfund,
baby
Remediate my landscape all
night long

CHORUS

And if you wanna find some
beauty, you'll find it
Succession is a valuable tool
But any patch of laurel that you
find
Was rooted in the slurry before
you

And there are tadpoles in the
languishing craters
Maybe the occasional frog
Told ya I'm a Superfund, baby
I'll remediate my landscape
when you're gone

Deadloop

Always gonna be lonely
Always gonna be sad
Always gonna be thinking 'bout the
things that I don't have
Always gonna be clumsy
Always gonna be dumb
Always gonna write songs too over-
wrought to mean a fuck
Always gonna be sorry
Always gonna be wrong
Always gonna wonder where I'll end
up when I screw the fucking dog

CHORUS

Always gonna say I'm never
gonna be as clever as my dad
wanted me to be
But after all, I'm doing better
than the dice's snake eyes see
So whatever quantum bullshit is
or isn't happening in my brain
Fuck the expectations, and oh
yeah, fuck the state

Fuck being lonely
Fuck being sad

Fuck always thinking 'bout the things
that I don't have
Fuck being clumsy
Fuck being dumb and
Fuck always feeling like the words I
write are dealing empty hands
Fuck being sorry
Fuck being wrong and
Fuck all the condescending bastards
that'll never understand

Cause I'm a multitude-
containing, absent-minded fuck-
ing dunce

And some of all those vectors
sure enough point elsewhere than
but up

But wherever this bag of cold-
cuts takes me that controls my
fate

Fuck the expectations, and oh
yeah, fuck the state

CHORUS [and while we're at it
fuck the state]

You wrote 'em

I'm struggling to turn words into any
kind of truth I can find anything
to hang on

To make thunderous nonsense show
all of the parts that I hate

And I got no intention of learning
anything I can bank on

But I'll be standing up here singing
to anyone listening 'til late

Mother of loves lost and banished,
move me to sing an unspeakable
truth someone'll heed

Send cleverly planted ideas that'll
grow like a seed

If any among you can find any sub-
stance in any of the words that I
say

You wrote 'em

CHORUS You wrote 'em;
didn't put 'em to paper but you
might just as well have held the
pen

You wrote 'em; didn't come out
of your lungs but your vacuum,
it left me the wind

You wrote 'em; you didn't
bloody your fingers to save an

unsaveable rhyme

You wrote 'em; and you cer-
tainly didn't arrange 'em to
match with the time But
you wrote 'em

I'm alone here again, with the com-
pany of the cross I so eagerly
carry to bleed on

And I'm pacing the boulevard with
pitiable paperboard signs

And even if you can't read 'em from
traffic and even if you just keep
keepin' on

You wrote em

CHORUS

And if you're looking for meaning in
the cobbled-together, sanctimo-
nious shit that I write

Let me tell you right now that I ain't
got a clue

Cause you wrote 'em

CHORUS [sure as fuck didn't ar-
range 'em yourself to match with
the time]

Heat Death

I had a dream we watched Orion
fade away When the stars fell
off horizons on the threshold Of
where the universe expands a lit-
tle faster than we can We settled
on a blackened ledge above the
cold

When our bodies, both such as they
were, collided And the explo-
sions brought together settled
out With your entropy and mine
so separate, oh so intertwined
Collapsed to stasis, fell to rest,
and doubled down

CHORUS

Let our passions turn to heat
and dissipate Let our be-
ings detach the fire of our de-
signs Let everything we
want or wanted crumble into
dust Let our orbits wander
off and then decay And let
us die

All these bodies banging 'round and
giving way That make us who
we've found all these years on
And the answers aren't coming,

and you'll never find the light
Because the sun slid off our plane
before arriving into dawn

The flannel dress you wore when we
went out that evening When I
saw the child leaping from your
eyes Locked away, forgotten, ou-
bliette'd for the course The rising
chorus of our convolutions' joys
Sings "Let us die"

CHORUS

Let our passions turn to heat
and dissipate Let our be-
ings detach the fire of our de-
signs May all your comets
crash and burn and crumble into
dust Let their orbits wander
off and then decay Let our passions turn to heat
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CHORUS

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